NgModules vs Standalone Components

Why Angular moved on...
Angular ≤16 → Angular 17–21 🚀

What most developers still use vs what Angular recommends today

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ANGULAR REALITY CHECK

- Angular is at v21
- Most production apps still use NgModules

Why?

- 👉 Stability
- 👉 Large legacy codebases
- 👉 Migration cost

Framework evolves faster than real projects

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NGMODULES (TRADITIONAL ANGULAR)

- Core architecture till Angular v15
- Acts as a container

Manages:

- Components
- Directives
- Pipes
- Services
- Imports & Exports

📦 Module-first architecture

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NGMODULE-BASED APP

```ts
@NgModule({
  declarations: [ProductComponent],
  imports: [CommonModule],
})
export class ProductModule {}
```

😵 Multiple files

😵 Declarations & exports

😵 Boilerplate everywhere

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WHY DEVS GOT TIRED

❌ Too much boilerplate
❌ Hard to trace dependencies
❌ Confusing for beginners
❌ Overkill for small features
❌ Complex lazy loading

Powerful… but heavy

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ANGULAR ASKED A QUESTION

“Why can’t a component manage its own dependencies?”

💡 Answer → Standalone Components

Angular v14+

Standalone-first from v17+

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STANDALONE COMPONENT

Standalone Component

- No NgModule required
- Component owns its imports
- Can be lazy-loaded directly
- Cleaner & modern approach

🧩 Component-first architecture

```
@Component({
  standalone: true,
  imports: [CommonModule],
  template: `<h2>Products</h2>`
})
export class ProductComponent {}
```

✅ No module
✅ Less code
✅ Easy to understand

LAZY LOADING COMPARISON

NgModule ❌

```
loadChildren: () => import('./product.module')
```

Standalone ✅

```
loadComponent: () => import('./product.component')
```

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WHY ANGULAR RECOMMENDS IT

- ✅ Less boilerplate
- ✅ Easier lazy loading
- ✅ Better readability
- ✅ Faster onboarding
- ✅ Future-proof architecture

Modern Angular = Standalone

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WHY NGMODULES STILL EXIST

❌ Large apps already use them
❌ Migration cost is high
❌ Some libraries still expect modules
❌ Teams are used to old patterns

Enterprise reality matters

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DECISION GUIDE

- New app → ✅ Standalone
- Small / Medium app → ✅ Standalone
- Learning Angular → ✅ Standalone
- Large existing app → ❌ Keep NgModules
- Migration → 🔄 Hybrid approach

THE TRUTH

- NgModules are not dead
- Standalone is the future
- Angular supports both
- Choose based on project reality

ARE YOU STILL USING NGMODULES?

👇 Comment your project version

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